

HARSHA H J

Bengaluru, India (Willing to relocate to Germany)

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Summary

Retail expansion and fit-out leader with 18+ years who delivered multi-site rollouts, renovations, and maintenance across Retail, QSR, and clinics. Owned end-to-end delivery across site due diligence, design/MEP/HVAC, BOQ & CAPEX, vendor onboarding, execution, and handover. Demonstrated scale with 130+ openings from FY23 to FY25 and 500+ lifetime builds, and managed maintenance for 180+ clinics. Drove governance, quality/HSE, and schedule control across 20 concurrent sites with PM dashboards and stage gates. Earned the “Magic Hands” award for execution excellence and confirmed mobility for DACH roles.

Core Skills

- **Store Development:** Rollouts/NSO, renovations, relocations, handover readiness, tenant coordination
- **Program/Cost:** Multi-site delivery, CAPEX/BOQ/estimating, vendor/SLA control, risk/change management
- **Tools:** MS Project, AutoCAD, Excel, PM dashboards, estimation templates, checklists/hold points
- **Construction/MEP:** Shopfitting, interiors, MEP/HVAC, civil/electrical/plumbing, site compliance, QA/QC
- **Scheduling:** Critical path, approvals/permitting, stage-gates, audits, readiness gates, maintenance planning
- **Domains:** Retail/QSR/F&B, malls, clinics/wellness, corporate offices, authority/mall interfaces

Experience

VLCC

May 2023 – May 2025

General Manager – Head of Projects (Design, Execution & Maintenance)

Gurgaon, India

- Portfolio oversight for openings/renovations/relocations was held, 130+ sites delivered across IN & BD to handover.
- BOQ/CAPEX discipline, vendor SLAs & PM dashboards were implemented to stabilize cost, schedule & throughput.
- Preventive maintenance for 180+ clinics was governed, compliance & uptime were protected with planned cycles.
- Cross-functional alignment (Leasing, Legal, Marketing, IT, Ops) was coordinated across 20 concurrent sites.

Chaipoint

November 2021 – March 2023

Head Projects – AGM

Bengaluru, India

- NSO/reopen programs were led, 24 launches & 18 renovations delivered with design plans, schedules & QA gates.
- Vendor qualification, rate benchmarking & acceptance testing were enforced to maintain delivery integrity.
- Budget outcomes were improved, NSO costs were reduced by 16% and reopening costs by 27% vs. baselines.
- Status cadence with stakeholders was run, risks/critical path were surfaced early to protect go-live windows.

Bhartiya City Mall

June 2019 – November 2021

Senior Manager – Retail Design & Execution

Bengaluru, India

- Tenant design criteria/manuals were authored, submittals & regulatory approvals were streamlined for fit-outs.
- Design direction & standards were aligned as SPOC, concept-to-opening flow was kept on schedule.
- Approval cycle time was reduced by 20% via codified guides, checklists & PMC coordination.
- Formats delivered included QSR, coffee chains (Starbucks), supermarket, lifestyle brands & multiplex.

Lulu International Shopping Mall & Y Mall

February 2016 – May 2019

Manager – Retail Design & Delivery

India

- 160+ fit-outs/renovations/kiosks were coordinated, mall criteria were enforced across interiors & engineering.
- Schedules/milestones were planned, weekly/monthly reviews drove recovery actions where delays emerged.
- Store audits were executed, defects were rectified to protect safety, quality & operational readiness.
- Retail design manuals were drafted for upcoming malls, criteria were harmonized with stakeholders.

Yum Restaurants India (KFC/Pizza Hut – Equity Stores)

April 2011 – November 2015

Deputy Manager – Projects

South India

- 50+ equity builds/renovations were delivered across KA/TN/TG/Kerala, quality, cost & timeline standards were met.
- Site development, resource planning & material QC were coordinated, low-cost-best-value was enforced.
- Build cycle time was accelerated by 25–35% via sequencing, parallel fronts & contractor tracking.

Yum Restaurants India (KFC/Pizza Hut – Franchise Stores)

April 2011 – November 2015

Deputy Manager – Projects (Franchise)

South India

- Design & MEP integrations with franchise Operations were synchronized so that acceptance & handover were achieved as per plan.
- Franchisee fit-outs were supported with tendering inputs, vendor governance & mall/landlord coordination to protect brand standards, safety & quality.

Mantri Developers, Reliance Big Entertainment, Puravankara Projects

February 2010 – March 2011

Executive Engineer Projects, Executive Projects & Real Estate, Site Engineer

India

- Project/site engineering responsibilities were handled across civil/interiors, stakeholder interfaces were supported.
- Schedules, vendor coordination & reporting were maintained, cost/safety/quality adherence was ensured.
- Handover documentation & closeout activities were executed in line with supervisory direction and standards.

Education

Visvesvaraya Technological University (M. S. Ramaiah College)

2007

B.Tech in Civil Engineering

India

Certifications & Awards

- PMP – Project Management Professional (in progress)
- HSE/Fire Safety – Foundation Level
- “Magic Hands” – Execution Excellence Award (VLCC)

Languages

- English – Full Professional Proficiency (C1)
- German – Intermediate Working Proficiency (B1, in progress)